GOVERNMENT OF ANDHRA PRADESH

VIDESHI VIDYA DEEVENA SCHEME
Comprehensive Operational Blueprint, Eligibility Architecture, Financial Entitlement Matrix & Verification Workflow

1. Executive Summary & Policy Objectives

The Videshi Vidya Deevena Scheme, implemented by the Social Welfare Department of the Government of Andhra Pradesh, is a premier overseas education fellowship. It is specifically designed to eliminate financial barriers for meritorious students from marginalized and economically backward communities. By providing up to 100% financial assistance for globally accredited higher education, the state facilitates equitable human capital development, positioning underprivileged students at the forefront of global academic excellence.

Under the scheme's revised architecture, funding is tied directly to prestigious international benchmarks, specifically the QS World University Rankings or Times Higher Education (THE) Top 200. This ensures that public resources sponsor access to premier global research facilities and elite faculties in Science, Technology, Engineering, Mathematics, Medicine, and Humanities.

2. Financial Assistance & Ranking-Tier Entitlements

Financial disbursements are structured across two clear tiers based on institutional prestige, with total permissible assistance reaching up to 1.50 Crore per student.

- **Top 1 to 100 (QS/THE World Rankings):** Beneficiaries are entitled to 100% of their tuition fees completely reimbursed for the course duration. The maximum cap for this tier is up to 1.50 Crore, strictly based on actuals as per the I-20, CAS, or official Fee Schedule. Ancillary expenses covered include a one-way economy class airfare, visa processing charges, and mandatory insurance.
- **Top 101 to 200 (QS/THE World Rankings):** Beneficiaries are entitled to 50% of their tuition fees or a fixed ceiling limit. The maximum cap is 50.00 Lakhs, whichever is lower between 50% of the tuition or the 50 Lakh limit. Ancillary expenses covered for this tier include a one-way economy class airfare and visa processing charges.

3. Disbursement Mechanics: Four-Stage Installment Lifecycle

To safeguard state capital and ensure academic milestones are met, financial aid is released directly to the candidate's designated foreign currency account or institution in four progressive installments.

- **Installment 1 (25%):** The first tranche is released upon obtaining an official Visa, providing a stamped passport copy, and the production of a Landing Permit or I-94 Arrival Card upon reaching the destination.
- **Installment 2 (25%):** The second tranche requires the production and online verification of the 1st Semester or 1st Term Results, alongside a continuing enrollment certificate from the university.
- **Installment 3 (25%):** The third tranche is released upon the production and verification of the 2nd Semester or 2nd Term Results, demonstrating satisfactory academic GPA and progress.
- **Installment 4 (25%):** The final tranche is released following the successful completion of the 4th Semester or Final Program Dissertation, along with the uploading of final grade sheets.

Note: For Ph.D. and MBBS programs spanning longer durations, progressive disbursements align with annual university grade reports and supervisor evaluations.

4. Comprehensive Eligibility Criteria

A. Demographic & Socio-Economic Limits

- **Nativity:** The applicant must be a domicile/native of Andhra Pradesh.
- **Eligible Social Categories:** Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST), Backward Classes (BC), Economically Backward Classes (EBC, including Kapu), and Religious Minorities.
- **Annual Family Income Ceiling:** Total household income from all sources must not exceed Rs. 8,00,000 (8.00 Lakhs per annum), validated by an official Income Certificate issued by Revenue Authorities.
- **Age Restriction:** The applicant must not have exceeded 35 years of age as on the notification publication date.
- **Single Beneficiary Proviso:** Only one student per family is eligible for assistance across the scheme's lifetime. Multiple siblings cannot claim this grant simultaneously or consecutively.
- **Statutory Inclusivity Quotas:** 33% reservation for women candidates and 3% reservation for Specially-Abled (PWD) students across all categories.

B. Academic Thresholds & Qualifying Exams

- **Postgraduate (PG) Degrees:** Minimum 60% marks or equivalent CGPA in a qualifying undergraduate degree.
- **Doctoral Studies (Ph.D.):** Minimum 60% marks in the corresponding Master's degree from a recognized institution.
- **Undergraduate Medical (MBBS):** Must secure admission in an eligible top-ranked medical faculty abroad alongside a valid qualifying scorecard in NEET-UG.
- **Standardized Tests:** Mandatory qualifying score in exams required by foreign institutions (GRE, GMAT, IELTS, TOEFL, PTE).

C. Eligible Countries & Priority Subject Fields

- **Approved Destinations:** USA, UK, Australia, Canada, Singapore, Germany, France, Japan, and other prominent destinations having QS Top 200 institutions.
- **Eligible Disciplines (21 Major Fields):** Engineering & Technology, Computer Sciences & AI, Data Sciences, Pure Sciences, Agricultural Sciences, Medicine & Public Health, Pharmacy, Economics & Finance, Business Administration, Humanities & International Relations.

5. Disqualifications, Conditions & Recovery Rules

- **Dual Scholarship Prohibition:** Applicants cannot draw overseas financial benefits from another Central or State scheme. A notarized affidavit is compulsory.
- **Conditional Admission Letters:** Conditional offer letters are summarily disqualified. Only unconditional offer letters from QS Top 200 institutions are accepted.
- **Course Discontinuation & Recovery:** Beneficiaries who abandon studies without institutional approval or fail to complete graduation are bound by a legal indemnity bond to refund the entire disbursed sum to the government with applicable interest.

6. Procedural Manual: Application & Selection Lifecycle

- **Stage 1 (Registration):** Candidate applies via jnanabhumi.ap.gov.in during biannual windows (Aug-Sep and Jan-Feb). Uploads unconditional admission letter, passport, and certificates.
- **Stage 2 (Verification):** Field verification of residency, family landholdings, caste credentials, and income limit conducted through Ward/Village Secretariats.
- **Stage 3 (Scrutiny):** State Level Screening Committee (SLSC), chaired by the Principal Secretary / Director of Social Welfare, scrutinizes institution rankings, transcripts, and financial status to approve the merit roster.
- **Stage 4 (Sanction & DBT):** Administrative sanction order issued. First installment credited directly to student account prior to departure upon visa issuance.

7. Mandatory Verification Document Checklist

- **Identity & Nativity:** Aadhaar Card (Applicant & Parents) and Integrated Caste & Domicile/Residence Certificate issued by MeeSeva/Revenue Department.
- **Financial Eligibility:** Certified Income Certificate (Below 8L), Family Ration Card / BPL Proof, and IT Return Acknowledgements.
- **Academic Credentials:** SSC, Intermediate, Degree Consolidated Marksheet, Degree Provisional/Convocation Certificate, and NEET-UG Rank Card (for MBBS).
- **International Admission:** Valid Unconditional Foreign Offer Letter, Proof of QS/THE World Ranking under Top 200, Valid Indian Passport & Student Visa, and GRE/GMAT/IELTS/TOEFL/PTE Scorecards.
- **Disbursement Setup:** Savings Bank Account details (Nationalized Bank passbook copy with IFSC) and Notarized Non-Availment Affidavit & Indemnity Bond.